

of those people? What will it take to get on the inside when one of those opportunities arise? Who has done or is doing what you want to do? What can you learn from them? This is part of developing the growth mindset that enables FI.

It's easy to say you need to connect with the right people. But how do you actually do it? Why would someone with the money, power, and influence you need care about you? If you're only worried about yourself and how people can help you, they probably won't.

Kristy of *Millennial Revolution* had an interesting idea. During her interview on the *ChooseFI* podcast, she said, "I think in the FI community, it's so easy for us to get along with each other because we really don't want anything from each other. You really know that people are just there to be authentic and to have your best interests at heart rather than just pushing things at you because they need a condition." This has been my experience in the FI community as well, but it misses a bigger point.

We can all take that approach to relationships. You don't have to be FI to be genuine, authentic, and caring. In fact, this may be a chicken-and-egg argument. Maybe being genuine, authentic, and caring sets people up for career success that enables FI because they add value to others. These traits also lead people to spend